

CineLog – Product Specification

MVP (Core Application)

1. What the App Is

A personal movie and TV show tracking web app where users can search for content, build a private watchlist, log watched items, and leave ratings and reviews.

2. User Stories

Authentication

- Register with username, email, and password
- Login and receive authentication token
- View own profile
- Restricted access without login

Movie Search

- Search movies/TV shows by title
- Results include title, poster, release year, overview
- View full details of selected item

Watchlist

- Add items with default 'want to watch'
- View full watchlist
- Filter by status
- Remove items

Logging a Watch

- Mark item as watched
- Auto record date watched
- Add rating (1–10)
- Optional review
- Update rating/review later

Stats

- Total watched items
- Average rating
- Most watched genre
- Recent watches

3. Business Rules

- One entry per movie per user
- Only watched items can be rated
- Rating must be 1–10
- Rating required, review optional
- Users manage only their own data
- Passwords must be hashed
- Auth required for protected routes

4. External Dependency

TMDB API provides movie and TV data. Frequently accessed data should be cached locally.

5. Frontend Requirements

- Landing page with login/register
- Search functionality via backend
- Movie detail page with add button
- Watchlist UI with filters
- Inline rating and review
- Stats dashboard
- Toast notifications

6. MVP Scope

Includes authentication, search, watchlist, logging, ratings, reviews, and basic stats.

Extensions (Future Features)

Social Features

- Public/private profiles
- Follow users
- Activity feed
- View others' watchlists and reviews

Recommendations

- Suggest content based on history
- “Because you liked X...” logic
- Extend to ML-based system

Lists

- Create custom lists
- Public/private lists
- Follow or save lists

Advanced Stats

- Total watch time
- Watching streaks
- Trends over time
- Rating distribution
- Top directors and actors

Notifications

- Release alerts
- New followers
- Interaction notifications

Reviews as Content

- Like reviews
- Discover popular reviews
- Trending movies